



Nadi — User Guide

Nadi is a resonant body inspired by the chakra map of the subtle body in Vedic and Tantrik metaphysics. It takes any audio you feed it and lets seven chakras resonate in sympathy, each tuned to the intervals of Indian ragas. Drums become temple bells, pads become drones, a voice becomes a choir of struck stone and singing crystal. In other words: a tool for generating sattva.

In plain terms, Nadi is a resonant multi-filter effect. It listens to your incoming audio and excites seven tuned resonator voices, animated by a moving point of energy called the **Kundalini** — a light that travels up and down the spine of the instrument, ringing each chakra it passes. You can use it subtly, as harmonic colour, or push it into drones, tuned feedback, rhythmic shimmer and self-resonating textures.

This guide explains every control — and, along the way, a little of the world the instrument comes from. You don't need any of that background to make beautiful sounds. But Nadi makes more sense, and is more fun, when you know what it is enacting.

Quick start

1. Insert Nadi on a track with audio playing through it
2. Choose a preset from the dropdown at the top-left
3. Adjust **Input** if the sound is too quiet or too loud
4. Use the **Mix** knob to blend dry and wet to taste

Tip: start with Output low when using high Resonance, Sustain or Feedback. Nadi can build energy quickly, especially on bass-heavy material.

That's enough to get going. Everything below is for shaping the sound further — and for understanding why the instrument behaves the way it does.

The world behind Nadi

In the yogic and tantrik traditions of India, the body you can touch is only the outermost of several bodies. Beneath the flesh lies the **subtle body** (*sūkṣma śarīra*) — an anatomy not of muscle and bone but of energy and awareness, mapped over centuries by practitioners who treated inner experience with the seriousness of cartographers.

Through this subtle body run the **nadis** — the channels, said to number seventy-two thousand, through which *prāṇa*, the life-current, flows. Three are paramount. **Ida**, the lunar channel, coils up the left side: cooling, receptive, inward. **Pingala**, the solar channel, mirrors it on the right: heating, active, outward. And between them rises **Sushumna**, the central column — the royal road. In ordinary life the breath and the mind shuttle between Ida and Pingala; the deeper practices of yoga exist largely to still that oscillation so the current can enter Sushumna and rise. These three channels give the plugin its name, and its Nadi selector its four paths.

Strung along the central channel are the **chakras** — literally "wheels" — the junctions where the nadis converge. Each is a centre of a different quality of consciousness: the root's gravity, the heart's openness, the crown's vastness. Nadi gives each one a voice.

And then there is **Shakti** herself. In tantra, Shakti is the Goddess — the dynamic, creative power of consciousness, pictured as a serpent (*kuṇḍalinī*) coiled and sleeping at the base of the spine. Awakened, she rises through the chakras toward union at and beyond the crown. The moving light you see sweeping Nadi's spine is exactly this image: the Kundalini ascending and descending, ringing each centre she touches. Nadi's chakra positions are selectively inspired by the twelve-centre system of the **Vijñāna Bhairava Tantra**, a foundational text of Kashmir Shaivism. From verse 29:

उद्गच्छन्तीं तडिद्रूपां प्रतिचक्रं क्रमात्क्रमम् ।
ऊर्ध्वं मुष्टित्रयं यावत्तावदन्ते महोदयः ॥ २९ ॥

udgacchantīm taḍid-rūpām prati-cakraṁ kramāt kramam |
ūrdhvaṁ muṣṭi-trayaṁ yāvat tāvad ante mahodayaḥ ||

[Imagine the śakti] rising like a streak of lightning from one subtle centre (cakra) to the next in succession. When She reaches the upper[most] centre, twelve finger-widths above the crown, there comes the Great Dawn [of liberation].

Following this Trika-inspired map, Nadi gives prominence to two supra-cranial centres above the physical crown — **Shakti** (four finger-widths above) and **Vyapini** (eight above), where the supreme Goddess is installed — rather than ending the journey at the head.

Those two names come from the science of mantra. In the Shaiva tantras, when the resonance of OM is raised through the body in practice (*uccāra*), it does not stop at the head: it dissolves upward through ever-subtler phases — *nāda*, *nādānta*, *śakti*, *vyāpinī*, *samanā*, *unmanā* — until sound passes beyond mind entirely at the *dvādaśānta*, the "end of twelve": the very twelve finger-widths above the crown named in the verse. Nadi's two highest chakras take their names, Shakti and Vyapini, from these phases of dissolving resonance. Which is also why the moving light is *not* called Shakti in this guide: the light is the Kundalini — the Goddess in motion — and the chakra named Shakti is one of the subtle stations she passes through.

Two more ideas from this world live inside the plugin. A **bandha** is a lock — a deliberate seal that contains the rising energy within a chosen region of the body instead of letting it disperse; Nadi's Bandha switch does precisely this to the Kundalini's travel. And underneath everything sits the Kashmir Shaiva teaching of **spanda**: the doctrine that reality itself is vibration — a single pulsation of consciousness appearing as all things. A tradition that understands the universe as vibration was always going to end up, sooner or later, inside an audio plugin.

The seven resonant bodies

Each chakra in Nadi is a resonant body modelled on a specific material, and the character of these materials shapes everything you hear. In **Ida**, **Pingala** and **Balanced** modes the materials are physical — things you could hold in your hands. Switch to

Sushumna and they transform into a second set: rarer and stranger, but no less real, drawn from the natural world's more exotic resonators.

- **Muladhara** (root) — Temple stone: deep, grounding, inharmonic, heavily damped highs. *Sushumna*: volcanic glass / obsidian — glassy clustered inharmonics, sharp ringing highs.
- **Manipura** (navel) — Clay pot / ghatam: hollow earthy body, brittle wall modes. *Sushumna*: resonant water — standing-wave patterns, fluid and tonal.
- **Anahata** (heart) — Bell metal: bright complex partials with a characteristic sharp second partial. *Sushumna*: magnetised metal — dense micro-resonance clusters, sharp and unpredictable.
- **Vishuddha** (throat) — Strings on wood: tanpura-like, warm, nearly harmonic with body resonances. *Sushumna*: aeolian wind cavity — air moving through a tuned space, breathy and open.
- **Ajna** (third eye) — Bamboo / vocal pipe: tube harmonics with breathy vocal character. *Sushumna*: tuned stalactite / lithophone — sparse, widely-spaced modes, pointillist.
- **Shakti** (four finger-widths above the crown) — Membrane / tabla: tuned loaded membrane, short precise attack with pitch bend. *Sushumna*: plasma resonance — modes following mathematical progressions, alien and luminous.
- **Vyapini** (eight above the crown — seat of the Goddess) — Crystal singing bowl: paired near-degenerate modes, slow beats and shimmer, very long sustain. *Sushumna*: bismuth crystal — golden-ratio paired modes, a geometric staircase.

Two ways the Kundalini moves: Sync and Free

Before the individual controls, one distinction unlocks everything else: the Kundalini can move in two fundamentally different ways, chosen by the **Sync** switch.

Free mode (Sync off) is the Kundalini on her own time. She sweeps at whatever speed the **Rate** knob sets, completely independent of your song. Stop your track and she keeps moving; narrow the Bandha to fewer chakras and she crosses that shorter distance faster, pinging quicker and busier. Free mode is alive and a little wild — it drifts against your music, phasing in and out of step with it. This is the mode for drones, evolving textures, sound design, and playing live input through Nadi without the DAW transport running at all.

Sync mode locks the Kundalini to your song's grid. Her position is derived directly from where you are in the bar, which means a groove you find is *reproducible*: stop and restart, or relaunch a clip, and the strikes land in exactly the same places every time. In Sync, the Bandha changes how *far* she travels, never how *fast* — the cadence stays locked to your chosen division no matter which chakras are active. When you press stop, the Kundalini freezes in place on the grid and any feedback build-up clears immediately, so the resonators simply ring out and fall silent. Press play, and everything comes straight back.

A simple way to hold the distinction: **Sync is for grooves you want to keep. Free is for textures you want to evolve.**

Top section — preset, paths, raga, sync

Preset

Loads one of the factory presets. The dropdown is organised into four categories — Drone, Perc, Bass and Melodic — so you can find material that suits your source at a glance; each preset's category is shown beside its name. Switching is instant, so cycling through to audition is smooth.

Nadi

Selects which channel of the subtle body the energy follows. Each has a different harmonic and rhythmic character:

- **Ida** — the lunar current: darker, bass-heavy, inward.
- **Pingala** — the solar current: brighter, more defined.
- **Sushumna** — the central channel: sweeping and meditative. This path switches the resonators to the transcendent material set described above.
- **Balanced** — Ida and Pingala running simultaneously; the most harmonious.

Rasa

Selects the emotional flavour by choosing a raga — a set of intervals the chakras tune to. In Indian music, *rasa* means the essence or taste of an emotion; each raga is a recipe for one. Choosing a Rasa retunes every chakra, and also sets that raga's traditional ascent-and-descent pattern on the chakra triangles (see *The ascent and the descent* below).

- **Default** — Mysterious and timeless; Nadi's original tuning, not based on any specific raga.
- **Bhairavi** — Universal and devotional; an all-hours rasa with earthy depth, softness and emotional breadth.
- **Yaman** — Luminous, romantic and evening-like; devotional sweetness with an expansive, upward glow.
- **Malkauns** — Nocturnal, tantric and inward; a deep midnight rasa of gravity, austerity and mystic stillness.
- **Bhairav** — Solemn, austere and dawn-like; a rasa of sacred gravity, discipline and awakening stillness.
- **Todi** — Yearning, tense and introspective; a late-morning rasa of longing, subtle unease and inward pull.
- **Megha** — Cooling, spacious and rain-charged; a monsoon rasa of longing, release and atmospheric bloom.
- **Pahadi** — Pastoral, mountain-like and open-air; a wandering rasa of innocence, nostalgia and gentle lyricism.
- **Marwa** — Austere and vast; the colour of the last light before dusk. Marwa has no fifth at all, and traditionally avoids settling on the root as it climbs — a rasa of suspended longing that refuses easy resolution.
- **Darbari** — Grave, slow and midnight-dark; the great court raga of Tansen, built on deeply flattened thirds and sixths. Feed it slow material and let the low chakras carry it.
- **Durga** — Open, devotional and fearless; a pure major pentatonic with no third and no seventh — nothing to make it lean, nothing to make it grieve. Everything it touches turns spacious.

- **Custom** — Set your own intervals per chakra (long-press a chakra's interval badge to choose). Your ascent/descent triangles are left exactly as you set them.

Sync and Sync Rate

The **Sync** switch chooses between the two modes described above. With Sync on, the dropdown beneath sets the division — how long the Kundalini takes to travel the spine in one direction:

4 Bars · 2 Bars · 1 Bar · 1/2 · 1/4 · 1/8 · 1/16 · 1/2T · 1/4T · 1/8T · 1/2. · 1/4. · 1/8.

The plain divisions are straight subdivisions of the bar; **1/16** is a flickering, near-granular shimmer at most tempos. The **T** divisions are *triplets*: three sweeps in the time you'd normally fit two, giving the motion a rolling, circular, shuffled feel. Triplets still divide your bar evenly — just into threes — so triplet grooves remain fully reproducible and sit beautifully against straight drums as a polyrhythm. The **dotted** divisions (marked .) last one-and-a-half times their plain value, and deliberately *don't* divide the bar evenly: the pattern lands somewhere different each bar and slowly turns around your loop, taking a few bars to come home. Choose dotted when you want the groove to breathe and evolve rather than repeat exactly.

Because dotted sweeps cross bar lines, relaunching a clip mid-pattern may catch them at a different point — part of their charm, but worth knowing.

Offset

The small slider beneath the Sync Rate shifts the Kundalini's entire journey relative to the downbeat, from 0% to 100% of one full sweep cycle. Think of the rhythm Nadi creates as a stencil laid over your bar: Offset slides the stencil. The pattern itself doesn't change — the same chakras ring in the same order at the same pace — but *where* the strikes land against your kick and snare changes completely. At 25% everything lands a quarter-cycle later, instantly syncopating the pattern; at 50% the journey is fully inverted, descending where it used to climb.

Offset is a real parameter, so your DAW can automate it — try riding it slowly across a transition and the whole groove rotates through the bar like a turning wheel. It applies in Sync mode only; Free mode has no grid to offset against.

Limiter

Catches peaks at the output. Use it when Nadi is bass-heavy or feedback is high.

Bandha

In yoga, a bandha is a lock — a seal that contains rising energy within a chosen region rather than letting it disperse. Nadi's Bandha does the same to the Kundalini: instead of sweeping the whole spine, she is confined between the lowest and highest *active* chakras, for a more focused sound.

Single-chakra steady mode: with Bandha on and only one chakra active, the Kundalini stops travelling altogether and holds steady on that single resonator — a sustained drone locked to one pitch, rather than the light wandering over silence. Activate a second chakra and motion resumes. This pairs beautifully with per-chakra Decay for shaping a single held tone, and with MIDI In for playing that drone melodically.

Auto Gain

Compensates for resonance build-up so Nadi is less likely to clip.

MIDI In

When on, incoming MIDI notes set the Sa (root pitch) of the entire instrument, letting you play Nadi melodically from a keyboard or sequencer. Switching MIDI In on automatically engages the Limiter as a safety measure (you can switch it back off if you wish): fast incoming notes at a low Sa can build resonant energy quickly, so it's wise to leave it on when playing this way.

Caution: with the Limiter off, fast notes at a low Sa can build energy fast and produce loud feedback. Keep the Limiter engaged in such cases.

The chakra faders (left side)

Seven faders, one per chakra, each named in Sanskrit — from **Vyapini** at the top, down through **Shakti**, **Ajna**, **Vishuddha**, **Anahata** and **Manipura** to **Muladhara** at the root. Each fader sets that chakra's presence in the resonant mix: pull one down to remove it, bring others up to emphasise their pitch and material character.

Vol / Pan / Dec

The toggle above the faders switches all seven between three modes. **Vol** — each fader sets that chakra's volume (the default). **Pan** — drag left or right to place that chakra in the stereo field; double-click to recentre. **Dec** — per-chakra Decay, described next.

Per-chakra Decay

In Dec mode each fader sets a decay *offset* for its chakra — how long it rings relative to the global Sustain knob. The faders are bipolar: centre is neutral, right makes that voice ring longer and lush, left makes it pluckier and more damped. Double-click to recentre. Because each chakra carries its own offset, you can have a tight, articulate root against a long, shimmering crown — and this is where much of Nadi's hypnotic, never-quite-repeating movement comes from: small differences in ring time keep the texture alive.

Solo a chakra

Shift-click any fader to solo it — only that chakra sounds, so you can audition one resonator and its material in isolation. Shift-click again to clear, or shift-click another to move the solo. The soloed chakra is marked with a cyan "S" and the others dim. Solo works in any fader mode, is a temporary monitoring aid (it isn't saved with presets), and a soloed chakra plays even if muted or pulled to zero.

Tip: solo a single chakra with Bandha on and Nadi drops into single-chakra steady mode — the quickest way to audition one resonator as a held drone.

Interval badges

The roman-numeral badges (I-VII) at the end of each name row choose that chakra's interval ratio: long-press to pick a different one (works in Custom rasa mode). Useful when one or two resonators sound awkward in context but you don't want to lose their voices entirely.

The ascent and the descent (the triangles)

This control comes straight from Indian classical music. A raga is never just a scale — it is a *way of moving*. Every raga prescribes an **aroha**, the path its notes take when ascending, and an **avaroha**, the path when descending — and crucially, these are often different. A raga might skip certain notes entirely on the way up, then welcome them

back on the way down: Pahadi climbs on five notes but descends through seven; Marwa famously avoids resting on the tonic during its ascent, creating a longing that resolves only as the line falls. This asymmetry between rising and falling is a large part of each raga's emotional fingerprint — its sense of question and answer, tension and release.

Nadi enacts this. Each chakra's name is framed by two small triangles. The ▲ **on the left** is its aroha marker: lit, the chakra sounds while the Kundalini *ascends*. The ▼ **on the right** is its avaroha marker: lit, it sounds while she *descends*. Both lit (the default) means the chakra rings in both directions.

Click any triangle to toggle it. A lit triangle glows warm saffron; an unlit one is a faint ember outline. One marker always remains lit — if you want a chakra silent altogether, use its fader or mute as usual. Choosing a Rasa sets the triangles to that raga's traditional pattern; your own clicks then override it until you next change the Rasa.

Call and response. The triangles turn Nadi from a pendulum into a conversation. Set some chakras to ascent-only and others to descent-only, and the rising sweep plays one phrase while the falling sweep answers with another — a built-in call-and-response that repeats, bar after bar, without a single note of programming. With a slow division and a long reverb, this is set-and-forget melodic storytelling: the question rises, the answer falls, indefinitely.

The right column — main controls

Eight pairs of dials, top to bottom:

Sa | Rate

Sa is the root pitch the chakras tune to; every interval is derived from it. A small note-name popup appears while adjusting, showing the current pitch in standard notation (e.g. A2, C#3). The dial is fully continuous — Nadi's tuning world is microtonal at heart, and sometimes the perfect root sits between the piano's keys — but **hold Shift while dragging** and it snaps to exact semitones when you want to land precisely on a note. **Rate** sets the speed of the Kundalini's motion in Free mode; when Sync is on, the synced division takes over.

Input | Output

Input is the gain into the resonators; **Output** is the final gain after the wet/dry mix.

Attack | Sustain

Attack sets how quickly each chakra responds to the input — lower is snappier, higher is a slower swell. **Sustain** is the global ring time for all chakras: centre is neutral, right is longer and lusher, left is tighter and more articulate. Per-chakra Decay (in the fader Dec mode) offsets individual voices around this global setting.

Sympathy | Resonance

Sympathy sets how strongly the resonators cross-excite one another — sympathetic resonance, as in the sympathetic strings of a sitar or sarangi. Low keeps each chakra responding mostly to the input alone, for a purer, more separated tone; high lets the chakras feed each other, for a richer, more interwoven and noisier body. **Resonance** sets how much the chakras ring: low is whispered, high is aggressive shimmer.

Drift | Harmony

Drift adds slow random pitch wandering across the chakras — organic life. **Harmony** sets how strongly the chakras lock to the raga's intervals: low leaves each chakra independent, high pulls them into a unified harmonic structure.

LP Cut | HP Cut

Low-pass and high-pass filters on the wet (resonant) signal. Use them to keep the resonators in a chosen frequency range and tame the extremes.

Aura | Feedback

Aura adds definition and a touch of air to the resonant signal — at higher settings the chakras gain a fuller, more present quality without aggressive colouration. **Feedback** feeds the wet signal back into the resonators: small amounts give body; high amounts can self-oscillate, so use with care. In Sync mode, stopping the transport clears the feedback immediately — the resonators ring out naturally and fall silent rather than swelling after the music stops, and your feedback character returns the instant you press play. (Free mode keeps feedback live with the transport stopped, since Free mode is for playing without the transport at all.)

Mix | Glide

Mix is the dry/wet balance: 0% is bypass, 100% pure resonant signal. **Glide** is portamento for MIDI Sa changes — higher means smoother pitch transitions when playing from a keyboard.

Randomise

Below the Mix and Glide dials sits the **Randomise** button. One click rolls a fresh resonant character: a new raga (with its ascent-and-descent pattern), a new nadi path, a new sync division, new sweep shape, sympathy, harmony, energy, and a new combination of active chakras.

Randomise is designed to be usable every single time. The energy-related controls — Resonance, Sustain and Feedback — share a budget, so a roll can be bold without ever compounding into a runaway howl: the hotter the resonance, the more the feedback is automatically reined in. And it deliberately never touches the things that anchor Nadi in your track — your Sa, your input, output and mix levels, your glide, or whether Sync is engaged. A roll changes the character, never your tuning or your gain staging.

Use it as an inspiration engine: play a loop, hammer the button until something catches your ear, then refine from there. Since each roll arrives with an authentic raga direction-pattern already in place, many rolls land with phrasing already built in.

The Ananda knob (the kundalini serpent)

The serpent at the bottom-left of the GUI is both a button and a knob — and it is, of course, the Kundalini herself: the same Goddess whose light you watch climbing the spine, here in her coiled, iconic form.

- **Click the serpent** to toggle **Grace** on or off. When on, Nadi occasionally generates a chord bloom of its own accord — a moment of beauty descending through the chakras. Auto-Grace events are random and don't always sound lush; the Goddess doesn't grant boons evenly.

- **Drag the serpent vertically** to drive **Ananda**, the manual Grace control. Like a synth filter cutoff: open it and a chord bloom rises from a hidden grace resonator bank. The bank is raga-aware and randomly inverts its chords each time the knob resets.

The Goddess bestows the light of pure knowing in proportion to the Ananda value. Use it to perform expressive accents over your audio — automate it, or play it live. Auto-Grace and Ananda coexist: you can leave auto-Grace on and still trigger manual descents whenever you wish.

The grace voice palette

Grace events are voiced by a separate resonator bank tuned to just-intonation chord intervals. Each voice is built from one of five sacred materials:

- **Warm Vessel** — creamy wooden bowl, low-register warmth
- **Lyrical String** — choral vowel, vocal middle range
- **Crown Glass** — crystal shimmer, upper air
- **Nectar Haze** — detuned pair with slow beating, woozy glow
- **Temple Aether** — high-Q fundamental with brass-bell upper partials, celestial

The grace engine selects from these based on the chord voicing and which chakras are active. Each descent is unique.

Tips

The preset dropdown is grouped by category to match your source material:

- **For drums:** try the Perc presets — Tribal Bells, Hypnotic Tabla, Slow Devotion, Banyan, Devotional Sequence, 432 Chimes. Drum loops excite the resonators with rich transient energy.
- **For pads:** try the Drone presets — Sahasrara Bath, Temple Cellar, Heart Chakra Bath, Crystal Choir, Om. Sustained material gives the resonators time to bloom.
- **For bass:** try the Bass presets — Heartbeat, Tribal Bones, Temple Pulse, Bowed Subharmonic, Forest Gleam. Tuned for low-frequency richness; engage the Limiter if peaks get hot.
- **For melodic and rhythmic accents:** try the Melodic presets — Mystic Cycle, Summergod, Robogasm, Lakeside Voices, Polyphasic Bliss.

Of course, presets can have interesting results on any material — Nadi is all about happy accidents. If a preset feels too intense, lower Mix or pull down Resonance. If it feels too tame, push Sustain to the right or open Drift. For per-voice shaping, switch the faders to Dec mode and pull individual chakras pluckier or lusher. And when nothing is catching your ear, hit Randomise.

In Sync mode, grooves are reproducible by design — stop, restart, or relaunch a clip and the strikes land in the same places, so a pattern you love is yours to keep. In Free mode the drift *is* the point: the texture never quite repeats, so when something magical happens, hit record.

Recommended workflow

1. Drop Nadi on the track

2. Try presets matching your source — the Drone / Perc / Bass / Melodic groups point the way
3. Adjust **Input** for level, and open **Mix** to taste
4. Shape individual voices with the chakra faders — Vol to balance, Pan to spread, Dec to set each voice's ring time
5. Sculpt the phrasing with the triangles — gate some chakras to the ascent, others to the descent
6. If syncing to your DAW, turn on **Sync**, choose a division, and slide **Offset** until the groove sits right against your drums
7. Click the serpent for occasional automatic blooms; drag it to perform **Ananda** accents over key moments
8. Stuck? Hit **Randomise** until something catches your ear, then refine
9. When something magical happens, hit record

That's it. Nadi rewards experimentation more than careful programming. Find a preset, push a few knobs, and listen.

The wider current

Nadi is one instrument in a larger project. Sattvagenic exists at the meeting point of the tantrik map of consciousness and the tools of electronic sound — taking the old cartographies of vibration seriously enough to build with them. If the ideas in this guide caught something in you — the subtle body, the rising Kundalini, a universe made of vibration — the Vijñāna Bhairava Tantra is a remarkable place to begin reading, and there is more to explore, hear and play with at **sattvagenic.com**.

Credits

Nadi is built with the JUCE framework. The output limiter is a lookahead design from the Signalsmith Audio DSP library by Geraint Luff, used with gratitude under the MIT licence. The Devanagari text in this guide is set in Noto Sans Devanagari.